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FREE GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

Low-Competition Product Ideas: Beginner's Starter Pack

Starting to sell online doesn't need expensive tools or complicated plans. This starter pack shows you how to find good product ideas for Nigerian buyers without spending much money or...



6 pages · PDF

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Starting to sell online doesn't need expensive tools or complicated plans. This starter pack shows you how to find good product ideas for Nigerian buyers without spending much money or getting confused.

01 Free Research Tools (Your Core Toolkit)

Google Trends is your best starting point. It is free and shows what people are searching for. Set the country to Nigeria, type a product like "shea butter" or "hair bonnet", and check if interest is growing or falling over the past 12 months.

TikTok Creative Center is TikTok's own free tool. It shows trending products, hashtags and ads that are working. Search product hashtags to see what is catching on before everyone joins.

Jumia and Konga best sellers show what Nigerians are buying right now. Browse categories and note products with a good number of reviews but not too many sellers. That middle ground means people want the product, but the market is not crowded.

Jiji shows what people are selling and asking for in every state. Search a product and compare prices, how many sellers there are, and how quickly listings change.

Instagram and Facebook Marketplace help you spot products with strong visual appeal. Posts with lots of comments asking "How much?" or "Do you deliver to Abuja?" point to demand that is not yet saturated.

02 Your Step-by-Step Research Process

Step 1: Start with problems, not products. Browse Nairaland, Facebook groups, X (Twitter) threads and comment sections. Look for repeated complaints. Phrases like "I wish someone sold…" or "Where can I buy… in Port Harcourt?" show real gaps you can fill.

Step 2: Check search interest. Use Google Keyword Planner (free with a Google Ads account) and Google Trends to see how often people search for a product in Nigeria. You want steady interest, but not a market already owned by big brands.

Step 3: Study the competition. Search your idea on Jumia, Konga, Jiji and Instagram. Count the active sellers. A handful of sellers proves demand; a few hundred means a crowded market. Read the 2– and 3–star reviews to find what buyers wish was better.

Step 4: Check social proof. Search the idea on Instagram, TikTok and YouTube. Moderate engagement (not millions of views) shows growing interest without too much competition.

03 Budget-Based Tool Plan

Just starting (0–10 sales a month): use free tools only, like Google Trends, TikTok Creative Center, Jumia, Konga and Jiji.

Making 10–50 sales a month: you can consider a paid product research tool. Most are billed in US dollars, so check the exchange rate and start with any free plan. Before paying, browse verified Nigerian suppliers on Shopinbos to see which products they stock and can dropship for you.

04 Your First Week Action Plan

Days 1–2: Spend 2 hours on Nairaland, TikTok and Facebook groups in areas that interest you. Write down 10 problems people mention again and again.

Days 3–4: Use Google Trends and Jumia or Konga best sellers to check which problems have real demand. Narrow your list to 5 product ideas.

Days 5–6: Check the competition on Jiji and Instagram, and read 2– and 3–star reviews for each idea. Note what customers wish was better.

Day 7: Use TikTok and Instagram to confirm the products look good on camera and people are talking about them. Choose your top 2 ideas to test.

Seasonal tip: plan ahead for big buying times like Valentine's, Easter, Eid, back-to-school in September, Black Friday and Detty December.

05 Critical Success Factors

Many new products fail because sellers don't understand what their customers really need. Proper research helps prevent this.

Focus on solving a clear problem for a specific group rather than trying to please everyone. New mums, students, people working from home, or naturalistas with 4C hair all have needs that general products don't meet well. For example, Halima in Kano noticed women asking for travel-size perfume oils, and she started there.

06 Next Steps

Ready to test your ideas? Visit Shopinbos to find verified Nigerian suppliers, add products to your store in a few taps, and sell on WhatsApp, Instagram, TikTok and Facebook.

Remember: successful sellers don't find product ideas by luck. They follow a simple process that finds real customer needs. Start with these free tools, take time to research properly, and grow as

your sales grow.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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